Newsletter Number 58

CIVIC SOCIETY
GREAT YARMOUTH

RECENT MEETINGS

Tuesday 22 September at 7.30pm in Old Priory, behind the Old Vicarage.
Richard Gallard. "The introduction of the Railways to Great Yarmouth"

Richard has had a life-long interest in railways and he gave an illustrated talk about how the railways came to and from Great Yarmouth. The first rail service came from Norwich via Reedham and was opened on 1 May 1844. The service terminated at Vauxhall. In the 1880s work started on a new line from Norwich Thorpe to Vauxhall via Acle. This is the most frequent service between Norwich and Great Yarmouth although there are a few services via Reedham each day.

Yarmouth Beach Station adjacent to Nelson Road was opened in 1877. It brought holiday makers from the Midlands and took a route around the Norfolk Coast. It was closed in 1959.

Yarmouth South Town Station faced the Haven Bridge and was opened in 1859. It travelled south via Gorleston and Lowestoft to London. It closed in 1970 and the A47 runs along the course of the railway line as far as Gorleston.

The Breydon Viaduct containing a swing bridge connected Beach Station with South Town and was completed in 1903. It was closed in 1953.

Tuesday 22 September AGM

Civic Society of Great Yarmouth
Annual General Meeting
Tuesday 22 September, 2026 at The Old Priory

1. Apologies for absence. Noted
2. Minutes of AGM 30.9.25. Accepted
3. Report of 2025-26. This had been circulated electronically and paper copies were available at the meeting.
4. Financial Report ending June 30 2026. Details in Annual Report.Presented by Susan Page and approved.
5. Reappointment of our President: Henry Cator
6. Appointment of our committee. Present committee re-elected

7. Election of new committee members: Pete Huggins and Sandy Payne
8. Plans for coming year
   Tuesday 27 October. Talk by Lorraine Finch on Conservation
   Tuesday 3 November. Visit to Sizewell
   Tuesday 24 November. Talk by Cllr Daniel Candon on proposed South Denes Development
9. Future meetings. Timing and days of week. The majority of people preferred to have meetings in the afternoons rather than in the evenings.
10. Any other business. None

Tuesday 27 October at 7.30pm in the Old Priory, behind the Old Vicarage.
Lorraine Finch, BA Hons, MA, ACR, CF, FRSA.
She has a national and international reputation for sustainability and cultural heritage conservation especially of archives and photographic material. She was recently awarded the Plowden Medal which was endowed by the Royal Warrant Holders Association and is the equivalent of an Oscar.

Her talk was based around her career and illustrated with anecdotes. Having qualified at the Camberwell College of Arts she went to the University of Southampton. Moulds attacking paper is increasingly common. She showed some of the instruments she uses and explained that old papers had the advantage of being made with long fibres often of cotton. She had worked on papers belonging to the Duke of Wellington and a letter written by Lord Nelson the day before he died. This and other papers of his had been shown on television. She had been involved in the Great Yarmouth Parish Library books which were in St. Nicholas Church at the time it was bombed in 1942. Many of them sustained water damage at the time and are now stored in Norwich Cathedral.

She had worked on papers at Aviva and at the National Army Museum and one day was hit in the leg when a rifle was being tested.

Lorraine has recently moved to Diss to obtain easier access to London but if anyone wishes to make use of her services she can be contacted via paperconservation@btinternet.com
Above is one of her slides showing the condition of some of the papers she has to deal with. These were some of the Duke of Wellington's papers
SATURDAY 24 OCTOBER

MEETING OF CIVIC SOCIETIES FROM NORFOLK AND SUFFOLK 24.1.26
Susan Page and Hugh Sturzaker attended this meeting in Kings Lynn. The aim is to discuss issues affecting local Civic Societies and feed up the results of discussion to Civic Voice which represents all civic societies. The minutes of the meeting are at the end of this Newsletter.

NEXT MEET|ING. Tuesday 24 November at 2.30pm in Old Priory
Daniel Candon. South Denes: A New Chapter for Great Yarmouth:
A masterplan for investment, jobs and long-term growth

GREENING UP GREAT YARMOUTH

We are replanting the Planters we provided in the Market Place with plants which will last the Winter. If you would like to help let me know at hsturzaker@icloud.com. Next session is on Wednesday 4 November at 10am meeting opposite the Priory School on the east side of the Market Place. We will be extending the planters along part of King Street.

AWARDS TO SHOPS BUSINESSES AND MARKET STALLS

All the shops, businesses and market stalls in the area of the Town Centre Partnership have been assessed and the winners will be announced in the Assembly Room of the Town Hall on Thursday 12 November. At the same time the winner of the Halloween Window Display will be announced.

Create Yarmouth '26: Melodies of Home at St. George's Theatre NR30 2PG

Date 5 Nov 2026. 6.30 - 7.30pm

Presented by Sinfonia Smith Square in collaboration with Orchestras Live and Norfolk and Suffolk Music Hub

Join the dynamic young orchestra Sinfonia Smith Square with St Nicholas' Priory Primary School, Freshly Greated and GYROS for a vibrant celebration of Great Yarmouth's stories - past and present. After a week of music-making, conversation and creativity across the town, performers of all ages come together for a one-night event that blends orchestral power with the voices, memories and imaginations of local people. Expect an uplifting, informal evening full of great music that captures the pulse of Yarmouth today.

Suitable for all ages. Tickets: £6. Book on line with St. George's Theatre.

NEW WEBSITE. www.civicsocietygy.uk

Best wishes,
Hugh Sturzaker
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